

The Law Catches Up

A law student posted, on his Facebook page, a libellous picture of his university president. Authorities spotted it and gave the aspiring lawyer two options—apologise publicly or defend his actions legally. The student submitted a legal brief to his dean, but the prof. didn't find any merit there—and he will now face suspension. Lawyers!!

facebook

Nigerian Visa Scan

Bill Gates recently needed to go to Nigeria. The plans were ready, but the visa wasn't yet available... Nigerian immigration reported that until they were sure Gates wasn't planning to stay on in the country permanently, putting a strain on the country's social services, he wouldn't be allowed in. They *did* finally relent!



Escape

LEAKY FILTER

Porn, Down Under

Kids today... It has been proven that children will do anything they can to upset the well-intentioned plans of their elders. And if that means hacking into porn filters and posting a DIY on YouTube for other oppressed teenagers—didn't the Bard say everything was fair and all that?

The Australian government, apparently worried over the proliferation of online smut and resulting corrupting of morals, dumped A\$84 million (about Rs 250 crore) into a state-of-the-art porn filter. They then collectively sat back, hoping to look over benignly as the hormone-affected population browsed National Geographic and Popular Science. But young Tom Wood—all of 16 years old—stuck a mighty blow in favour of free speech (or

insolent defiance, depending on your political leanings) by proving in 30 minutes that the filter was nothing but a fancy piece of eye-candy. He was immediately hailed as a genius and saviour, while embarrassed officials scrambled to plug in the holes—without much success. The only comment from the authorities was that good parenting was much better than any technology. Needn't have wasted millions to find that out, eh?

All the above happened in August. Considering that this was a pet project of Aussie premier John Howard, you would have expected that they would remove all the loopholes after all that publicity. Turns out, the thing is as leaky as ever—when the original hacker took it out for a spin, it still let in stuff

that wasn't supposed to be in. And so other kids could take advantage of this, he posted a detailed video on YouTube mentioning the steps necessary for a free inflow of porn on computers with the filters enabled. At the time of writing, the technicians were still scratching their heads. We're sticking our neck out on this—they'll continue scratching for a long time!

SIGNUP BLUES

U Joinin', Dude?

If you happen to read a recent presentation of the US Navy, don't be surprised if your first thought is, "Are they conducting a cultural orientation course for an invading force?" Well, we thought the same way, until we looked harder and found out it was a presentation for

Whatever Happened To...

Multi-angle Movies

Back when the DVD first came out (feels like so long, doesn't it?), movie studios didn't really know what to do with all that space—a typical 2-hour movie barely filled up two VCDs (1.4 GB); what were they supposed to do with 4.7 GB of space? One of the more brilliant ideas was the multi-angle movie—don't like the camera angle the director's chosen to show? Change it! You could watch races and matches from whatever angle you chose!

Nice plan, but Hollywood had their priorities—they kicked up the video resolution, added subtitles in multiple languages and lavished us with higher-quality 5.1 channel audio. When it came to the final touch—viz. the multi-angle movies—they backed out. Shooting scenes from multiple angles meant higher production costs, and it interfered with the "directors' artistic vision"—you are supposed to watch movies the way they want you to.

In fact, the only movie producers to embrace the idea of multi-angle movies were in the porn industry—for... ahem... obvious reasons. In fact, you can purchase multi-angle porn DVDs even today, though not in India, of course. In any case, the format hasn't really died per se—nearly all DVD players support it, but good luck finding a family-friendly movie with this option.

Win! My Desktop

Geno P T, Nagercoil, Tamil Nadu
How he did it:

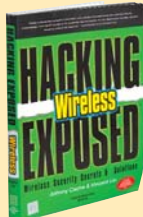
Edited the layout of the keyboard in the picture; used picture-to-icon software to convert part of the screen to icons; the icons were arranged in their exact locations on the wallpaper. Changed font sizes to merge the icons with the wallpaper. Used Top Themes XP to edit my customised taskbar. Used Magic Tray to remove the Start Button and Taskbar items. And removed the arrow in the IE and WMP shortcuts!

Participate in this contest and win next month

Hacking Wireless Exposed

by Johnny Cache & Vincent Liu
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Send us your desktop with a description of how you made it to mydesktop@thinkdigit.com with the subject "My Desktop", and tell us your postal address, too.